

PCF 3-Day Response Pack

A practical pack for manufacturers responding to a customer product carbon footprint request.

USE THIS WHEN

A customer asks for a product carbon footprint and gives you a short deadline.

THE GOAL

Send a transparent preliminary response in three days, then improve it with better data. A three-day preliminary response is not automatically an ISO 14067-compliant final report, a certification, or an independently verified result. State the status clearly.

72 HOURS

1. Customer clarification email

Copy, adapt, and send this before collecting data.

SUBJECT

Clarifying the PCF information requested for [Product / Model]

Hello [Name],

Thank you for your request for the product carbon footprint of [Product / Model]. To provide a result that is useful and comparable for your review, could you please confirm the points below?

Product and unit: Do you need the result per item, per kilogram, per tonne, or per order?

Included stages: Should we include raw materials, inbound transport, manufacturing, packaging, delivery, product use, and end of life?

Production site and period: Which site and reporting period should the result represent?

Output format: Do you need one preliminary number, a calculation file, a methodology note, a customer questionnaire, or a formal report?

Evidence requirement: Are supplier-specific data, a named database, a product category rule, or independent verification required?

Deadline and use: Will the result be used for internal screening, supplier comparison, a tender, a public claim, a contract, or another purpose?

Once we have this information, we will confirm the calculation scope, the data available, and the timing for a preliminary response.

Best regards,

[Name] | [Role / Company]

2. PCF data collection checklist

Start with the items most likely to change the result. Mark each item as ready, requested, or not applicable.

Product and materials

- ☐ Product model, version, and description
- ☐ BOM, recipe, or product specification
- ☐ Material names, grades, weights, and units
- ☐ Product quantity and production period
- ☐ Scrap, yield, and production loss
- ☐ Recycled content and supporting evidence

Factory and production

- ☐ Electricity use for the reporting period
- ☐ Natural gas, steam, fuel, or other energy use
- ☐ Production volume for the same period
- ☐ Method for assigning shared factory energy to this product
- ☐ Direct process emissions, if relevant
- ☐ Packaging and internal transport

Suppliers and logistics

- ☐ Supplier-specific carbon data, if available
- ☐ Supplier production data or material activity data
- ☐ Material origin and supplier location
- ☐ Transport mode, distance, and shipped weight
- ☐ Recycled-material or other environmental claim evidence

Calculation record

- ☐ Product unit is written clearly
- ☐ Included and excluded life-cycle stages are written clearly
- ☐ Reporting period and geography are recorded
- ☐ Each input has a source and unit
- ☐ Each conversion factor has a source, version, geography, and unit
- ☐ Assumptions, estimates, exclusions, and open requests are recorded

3. Three-day response-pack structure

Day	What to do	What to keep
Day 1 - Clarify and scope	Confirm product, unit, site, period, included stages, intended use, and evidence requirement.	One scope sentence, a data request list, and an owner for each missing item.
Day 2 - Calculate and document	Prepare the best available first estimate. Separate actual records from reference data.	Preliminary result, assumptions, exclusions, conversions, and data gaps.
Day 3 - Review and send	Perform a basic review and assemble the customer response.	A concise 3-5 page pack and a dated next-step plan.

Scope sentence template

We will estimate emissions for [Product], per [unit], made at [Site] using [period] data, covering [included stages]. The first response is for [intended use]. [Supplier data / independent review] is [complete / pending].

Day 3 response pack contents

- [] Executive result: product, unit, included stages, period, and preliminary result.
- [] Method summary: materials, energy, transport, packaging, allocation, and calculation approach.
- [] Data-source register: actual company or supplier records versus reference data.
- [] Gap and risk list: missing evidence, estimates, exclusions, and high-impact uncertainties.
- [] Next-step plan: data owner, action, target date, and review or verification requirement.

4. BOM readiness checklist

A BOM is usually enough to start a material-stage estimate, but not enough to claim a complete PCF.

Check	Yes	No	Notes
Product model and revision are confirmed	☐	☐	
Every material has a weight and unit	☐	☐	
Material grades or specifications are known	☐	☐	
Production loss or scrap is known	☐	☐	
Recycled content is supported by evidence	☐	☐	
Factory energy can be linked to the product	☐	☐	
Supplier or material origin is known	☐	☐	
Transport and packaging information is available	☐	☐	
Customer-required calculation stages are covered	☐	☐	

Interpretation

Score	What it means
7-9 Yes	Ready for a structured first PCF calculation; verify the high-impact inputs.
4-6 Yes	Ready for a preliminary estimate with a clear gap list.
0-3 Yes	Use the BOM to define the project and request more data before presenting a product-level result.

Never convert a BOM-only material estimate into a complete product carbon footprint without stating what is missing.

5. Preliminary estimate wording

Avoid	Use instead
This product emits 2.34 kg CO ₂ e.	Preliminary estimate: 2.34 kg CO ₂ e per product under the stated boundary and assumptions.
ISO 14067 certified.	Prepared with reference to ISO 14067; independent review has not been completed.
Supplier-specific footprint.	Estimate based partly on secondary reference data; supplier-specific information is pending.
Complete product carbon footprint.	The estimate covers [stages] and excludes [stages].
Accurate carbon number.	Best available estimate based on the data listed in the source register.

Customer-ready email wording

Attached is our preliminary product carbon footprint estimate for [Product], calculated per [unit] and covering [included stages]. The estimate uses [company / supplier data] and documented reference data where supplier-specific information is pending. The attachment lists the calculation boundary, assumptions, exclusions, data sources, and open requests. Independent verification has not yet been completed.

Final send checklist

- ☐ Product and unit are unambiguous
- ☐ Included and excluded stages are stated in plain language
- ☐ Production site, geography, and period are recorded
- ☐ Actual and reference data are separated
- ☐ Conversion-factor sources and versions are recorded
- ☐ Assumptions, estimates, and data gaps are visible
- ☐ Review status and next update date are included
- ☐ The wording does not imply certification or verification that has not happened

NEXT STEP

Need help turning your data into a traceable PCF workflow? Visit climate-seal.com to discuss your project requirements.

Sources: ISO 14067:2018; GHG Protocol Product Life Cycle Accounting and Reporting Standard.